

they should expertly guide you through the closing process. (You'll see how complicated this process is in Chapter Twelve. Trust us, you'll need all the help you can get.)

In return for meeting these expectations, your agent may have some reasonable expectations of you. They will expect you to know what type of home you want and to be ready to purchase when they present that home to you. In exchange for the work they do to help you research the local market and find a good deal, they will expect you to sign an exclusivity agreement, and for you to work with them for the duration of the purchase process.

And let's be real: Networking is hard. If it feels impossible to know how to articulate what "good" looks like when hiring an agent, lender, or any other professional who helps you in the home-buying process, that's okay. If your family, friends, and coworkers have very few recommendations, don't panic. Just try to meet a few people in each industry before making your selection. The clearer you are on what you want and the more knowledgeable you are, the better you will be able to assess each of these hires.

CHAPTER SUMMARY

- Unfortunately, you're no longer the ideal client for a "top" real estate agent. (We're not sorry—we're here to teach you how to best purchase a home for *your* needs. Agents can take care of themselves.) To mitigate this, make it clear to any potential agent that you have what a lot of first-time home buyers don't—you know exactly what you want, and you're willing to pull the trigger without hesitation.
- You need four main things from your agent. First, you want a few conversations about whether your home-buying expectations are realistic. Second, you need alerts from the MLS to see immediately when deals come online. Third, your agent should be immediately available and highly responsive when you need to act quickly on a good deal. Fourth, your agent should walk you through the entire process and answer any questions you may have. Find someone who meets all four requirements, and you're on the right track.